

AMERICAS ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICES

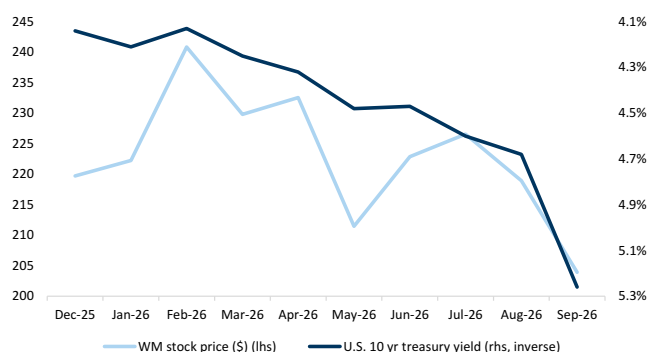
3Q preview: Valuations resetting lower, fundamentals intact

Since the end of the 2Q reporting season, our Environmental Services coverage has declined -8% versus the S&P 500 -2%. We have previously pointed out that the Waste sector exhibits bond-like characteristics, and we view the recent pullback as directly tied to the rise in the 10-year Treasury yield, which has increased to ~5.25% from ~4.65% at the end of 2Q reporting season. We subsequently lower our valuation multiples across the group from ~15x EV/EBITDA to ~14x EV/EBITDA. Our price target reductions this quarter reflect a reset of multiples to the higher rate backdrop, rather than a change in our fundamental view. We remain constructive as (i) we continue to view the industry's price-cost spread as durable, (ii) we see scope for outsized margin expansion (>50 bps) in 2027 and 2028 as AI investments flow through incremental to typical price-cost tailwinds, while recycled commodities continue their upcycle, and (iii) valuations appear fair to slightly below warranted levels based on our quantitative model. Heading into 3Q, we see upside to consensus estimates at RSG, CLH, and, to a lesser extent, WCN. We continue to highlight CWST (on the CL), which we believe offers the most significant M&A growth runway in our coverage while also delivering industry-leading organic growth (~7% in 2Q versus peers at 4%), yet now trades at an in-line valuation to peers vs our view that it warrants a relative premium. Our investor conversations have centered around 4 key themes ahead of the quarter that we highlight below:

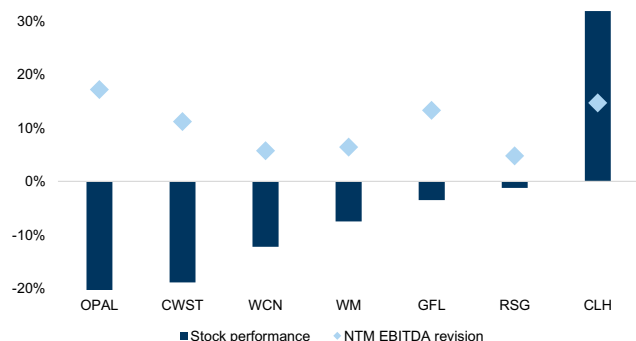
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Exhibit 1: WM stock price vs. U.S. 10 year treasury yield (inverse)

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet, FRED

Exhibit 3: Environmental Services stock performance vs NTM consensus EBITDA revisions since start of 2026

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Environmental Services coverage 3Q EBITDA estimates: GSe vs consensus

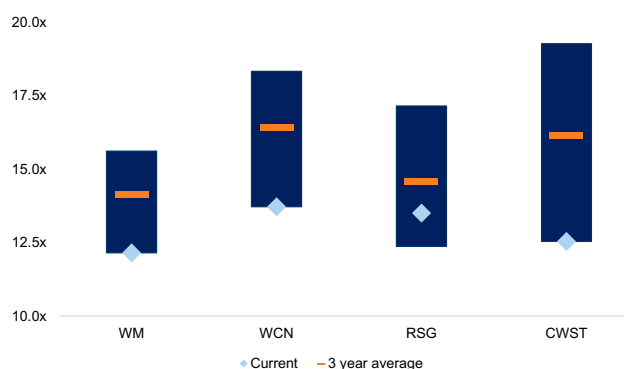
EBITDA 3Q26E			
Ticker	GS Est.	Consensus	% Diff
CLH	\$415	\$405	2.5%
CWST	\$135	\$136	(1.0%)
GFL	C\$669	C\$619	8.1%
OPAL	\$26	\$27	(1.5%)
RSG	\$1,451	\$1,437	0.9%
WCN	\$890	\$886	0.4%
WM	\$2,155	\$2,162	(0.3%)

We note that some of GFL consensus estimates have not yet incorporated the closing of the recent SECURE acquisition.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 4: Buy-rated Environmental Services coverage valuations are at 3 yr lows

NTM EV/EBITDA valuations vs 3 year average peak, trough, and average

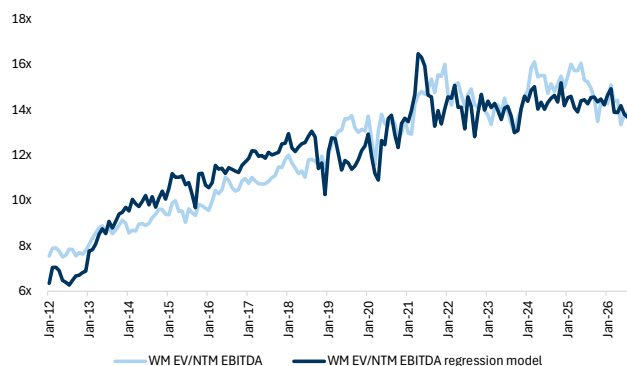


Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

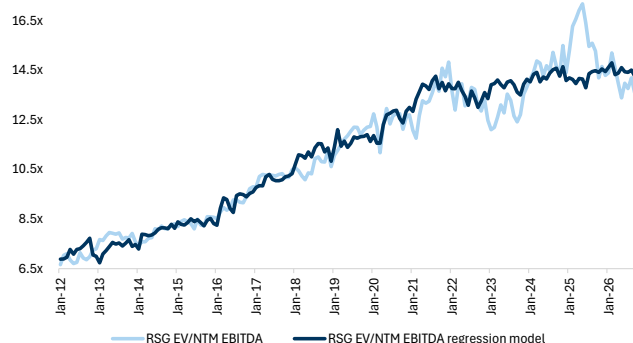
1. Can Waste valuations re-rate? Following the -7% pullback in Waste over the last month, valuations have moved to ~13x EV/EBITDA, ~1.5x below the three-year average, prompting investor questions around scope for multiple expansion. In this note, we introduce an Environmental Services valuation regression model ([Exhibit 6-Exhibit 9](#)) based on pricing, free cash flow conversion, and the S&P 500 Equal Weight multiple to provide a framework for evaluating valuation in the context of Waste fundamentals and broader market multiples. RSG, WM, WCN valuations are within 5% of what is warranted by our model, while CWST flags as having meaningful upside to current valuation. We exclude GFL from the analysis given its more limited trading history and the recent significant changes in its business mix. We also assess Waste's relative attractiveness versus fixed income ([Exhibit 5](#)) by comparing the sector's cash flow return profile (FCF yield plus pricing growth) against the 10-year Treasury yield. While this relative return spread has compressed toward historical lows due to higher Treasury yields and moderating pricing, this dynamic is not dissimilar from the broader market where equity risk premiums also remain near historical lows.

Exhibit 5: Waste sector FCF yield + core price less 10 year treasury

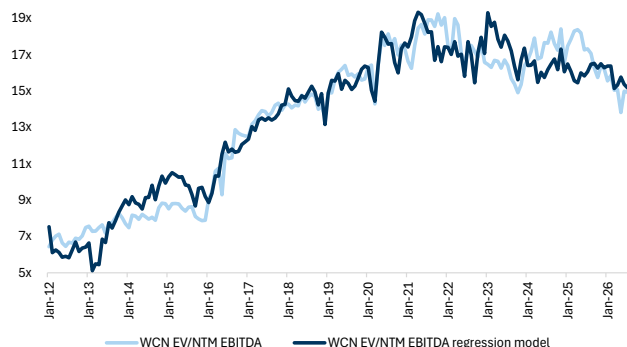
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 6: WM EV/NTM EBITDA regression model vs. actual EV/NTM EBITDA

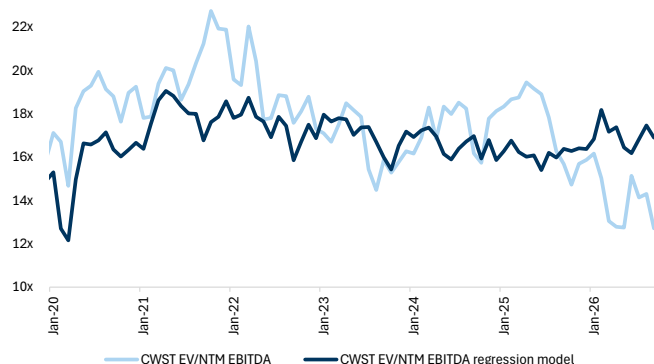
Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: RSG EV/NTM EBITDA regression model vs. actual EV/NTM EBITDA

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: WCN EV/NTM EBITDA regression model vs. actual EV/NTM EBITDA

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

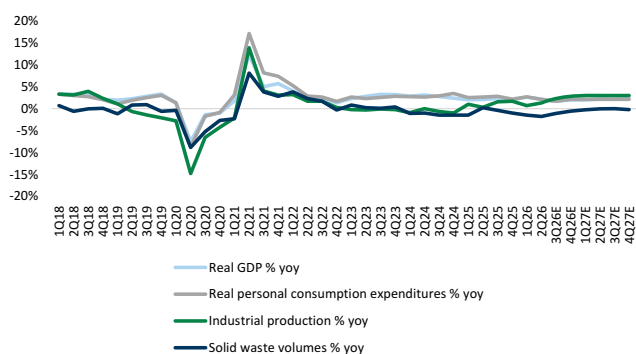
Exhibit 9: CWST EV/NTM EBITDA regression model vs. actual EV/NTM EBITDA

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

2. Are waste volumes being impacted by rising competitive intensity? We see heightened risk of competitive pressure in the current higher diesel price environment. Publicly traded operators generally pass through fuel cost increases relatively quickly via fuel surcharges, while private operators tend to react more slowly. Excluding fuel

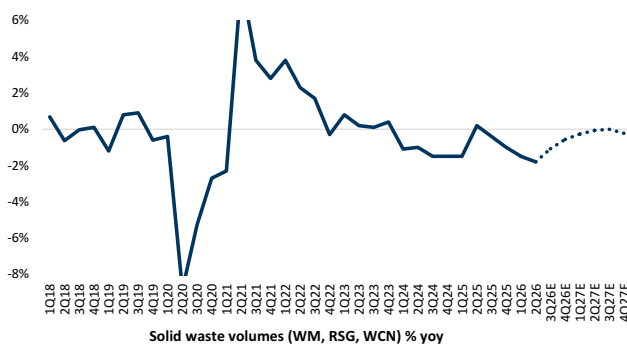
surcharges, our Solid Waste coverage already prices at a meaningful premium to private peers (Exhibit 12). On its most recent earnings call, Waste Connections noted that private haulers typically take three to nine months to adjust pricing for higher fuel costs and, in some cases, may use that as some competitive inroad. Conversely, RSG has not seen any meaningful change in the competitive environment compared to historical norms. Although solid waste volumes are down ~1.7% YTD, much of the weakness reflects the lapping of one-time event-driven landfill volumes from the prior year. Looking ahead, Waste Management guided to flattish volumes in 2H26 as it laps event-driven landfill volumes, while RSG expects volumes to exit the year roughly flat to slightly negative as it laps event-driven landfill volumes in 4Q. A key focus this quarter will be determining whether underlying industry volume trends are stabilizing around flat levels in 2H26 and whether rising fuel surcharges are having any measurable impact on competitive behavior.

Exhibit 10: Solid waste volumes % yoy vs macro indicators % yoy



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FRED

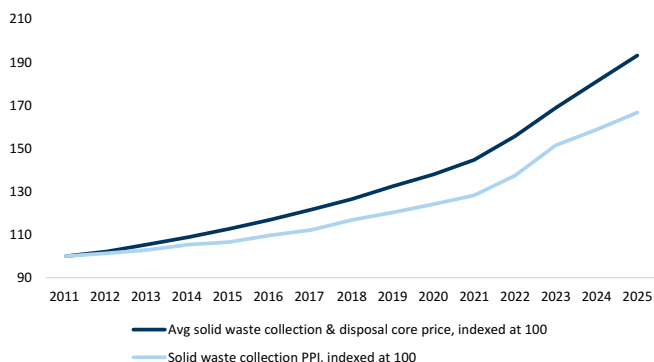
Exhibit 11: Solid waste volumes % change yoy



Forecast periods reflect our estimates

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: Solid waste core pricing index (WCN, WM, RSG) vs total collection industry pricing index



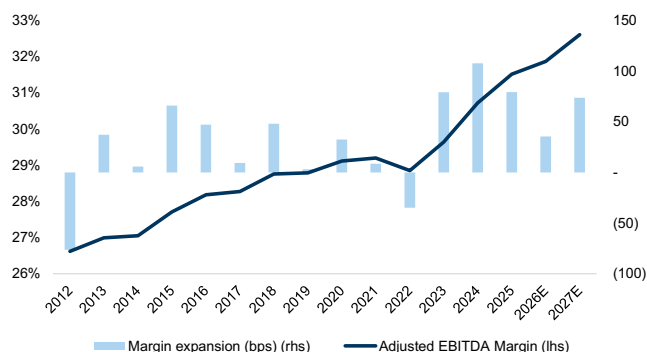
Source: Fred, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Company data, Bureau of Labor Statistics

3. 3Q results could provide greater visibility into potential for outsized margin expansion in 2027. While volume trends remain uncertain, we believe visibility should begin to emerge on the potential for outsized margin expansion in 2027. Whereas 2026 was characterized by several macro and one-time factors that obscured underlying

price-cost-driven margin expansion, we believe many of those headwinds should moderate in 2027 while new tailwinds emerge. Positive recycled commodity comparisons, continued ramp-up of sustainability investments, and AI-enabled productivity initiatives should all support margin expansion next year ahead of normal price/cost (30-50 bps tailwind).

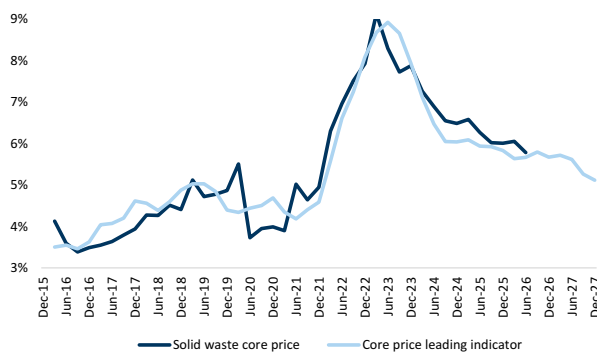
Exhibit 13: EBITDA margins have moved higher since 2012

Environmental Services EBITDA margins vs EBITDA margin expansion



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: GS core price leading indicator



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

4. Recycled commodity price moves: tailwinds in OCC and base oil, headwinds from D3 RIN.

- **Our Environmental Services recycling price tracker is +9% sequentially in 3Q vs 2Q, led by higher recycled cardboard prices.** OCC prices are tracking \$79 per ton in 3Q, up +23% sequentially and +43% yoy, extending the recovery from the cycle trough of \$44 per ton in December 2025. The continued move higher in OCC prices is being balanced by mixed sequential plastics pricing trends, although plastics pricing remains up yoy. We estimate every 10% move in recycling prices translates to a ~0.4% EBITDA impact on average for our coverage and nearly 2x the impact to EPS and FCF. We see WCN as the biggest beneficiary in a rising recycling price environment as a 15% move higher in recycling prices translates into a ~1% tailwind to EBITDA for WCN.
- **Our base oil price tracker increased 7% sequentially and 42% yoy in 3Q, with current run-rate pricing ~5% above the 3Q average.** Base oil prices are relevant for CLH, as they drive pricing within the Safety-Kleen Sustainability Solutions business, which represents ~17% of company revenue. We now forecast Safety-Kleen Sustainability Solutions EBITDA of \$321 mn in 2026, up 134% yoy and well ahead of CLH's \$275 mn guidance for the segment, reflecting the sharp increase in base oil prices during the quarter. While prices remain elevated, our forecast assumes some moderation during 4Q, although the macro backdrop remains volatile and difficult to predict. We view risk to our 3Q and full year Safety-Kleen estimates as skewed to the upside.
- **D3 RIN prices fell to \$2.34 in 3Q26, down from \$2.56 in 2Q26, with current run-rate pricing at \$2.28.** Our Solid Waste coverage is entering the final phase of capital deployment across a pipeline of landfill gas projects that we expect will ramp

meaningfully over the next several years. We estimate landfill gas EBITDA contribution could increase from ~\$240 mn in 2025 to nearly \$800 mn by 2028 as the construction of existing project pipelines is completed and operating facilities continue to ramp production. At full run rate, we estimate that every \$0.25 change in D3 RIN pricing translates to a 0.4% swing in total company EBITDA across our Waste coverage universe, assuming 50% of volumes are contracted at fixed rates.

Exhibit 15: Old corrugated container (OCC) prices were +13% mom and +61% yoy in September



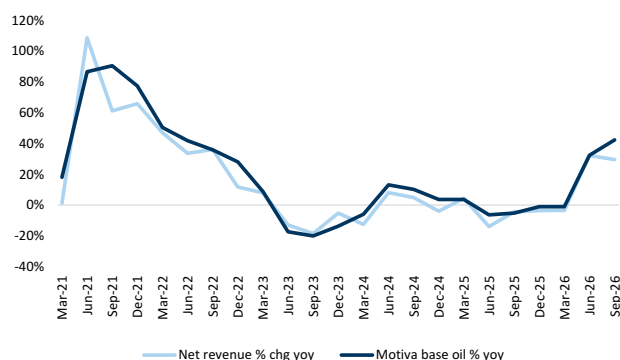
Source: Fastmarkets, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: D3 RIN prices vs historical average



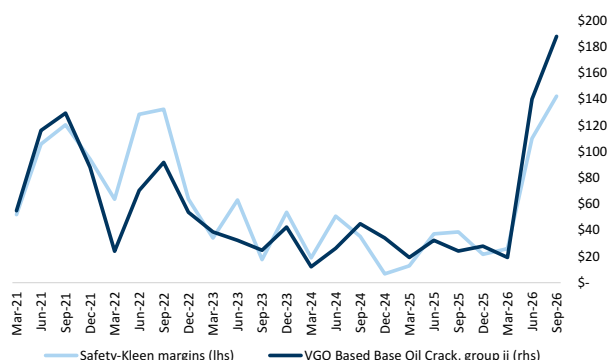
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: Safety-Kleen revenues % change yoy vs Motiva base oil price % change yoy



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 18: Safety-Kleen margins vs VGO Based Base Oil Crack, Group II



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Company data

What we are focused on into 3Q results?

Waste Management (WM, Buy)

- We expect key investor focus areas to be (i) the magnitude of the inflection in Healthcare Solutions revenue growth in 2H26 as WM laps peak AR credits, (ii) volume performance relative to management's expectation for relatively flat solid waste volumes in 2H26 amid ongoing investor questions around competitive intensity, and (iii) updates on landfill gas project timing and management's views on the incremental EBITDA contribution in 2026/2027 following the recent decline in

D3 RIN prices to \$2.28.

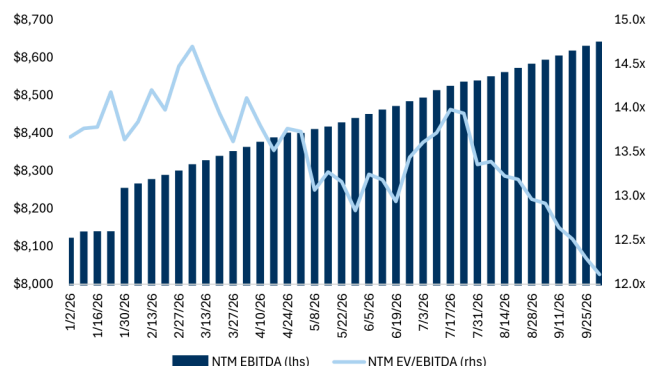
- On Stericycle, while revenue declined 1% yoy last quarter, WM noted that the business is now fully integrated and reiterated its expectation that customer credits issued during 2H25 will become a meaningful tailwind in 2H26 as those headwinds are lapped. However, for Healthcare Solutions to achieve mid-single-digit revenue growth for full-year 2026, in line with management's outlook, we believe revenue growth would need to accelerate relative to normal seasonality. We forecast 3% Healthcare Solutions revenue growth in 2H26 and ~1% revenue growth for the full year.
- While our 3Q solid waste volume forecast of -1% and 3Q Stericycle revenue growth forecast of +3% yoy remain slightly below management's outlook, our 3Q estimates still embed slight revenue upside vs consensus. We forecast 5.5% organic growth in 3Q versus 3.5% in 2Q, with the organic growth acceleration reflecting the lapping of event-related volume comps and improving recycling commodity prices.
- Despite the revenue upside, we expect 3Q EBITDA to be broadly in line with consensus, as our higher revenue assumptions are offset by slightly lower than consensus margin expectations. Consensus appears to be modeling margins somewhat ahead of the normal seasonal trajectory. We forecast 3Q EBITDA margin expansion of 43 bps yoy, driven by solid waste margin expansion, incremental contributions from landfill gas investments, and Stericycle synergy realization, more than offsetting the margin-dilutive impact of fuel surcharges. We would note that WM differs from peers in that higher recycling commodity prices, while positive for EBITDA dollars, are margin dilutive.

Exhibit 19: WM 3Q26 GSe vs consensus

WM	Gse 3Q26	Consensus 3Q26	Variance
Revenue (\$ mn)	\$ 6,831	\$ 6,801	0.4%
% yoy	6.0%	5.6%	0.5%
% qoq	2.2%	1.8%	0.5%
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	1.7%	1.7%	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	2.5%	2.5%	-
EBITDA (\$ mn)	\$ 2,155	\$ 2,162	(0.3%)
% margin	31.5%	31.8%	(24)
% margin yoy (bps)	43	67	(24)
% margin qoq (bps)	63	86	(24)
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	66	66	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	42	42	-

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 20: WM NTM EBITDA consensus estimate revisions vs NTM EV/EBITDA since start of 2026
\$ in mn



Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Republic Services (RSG, Buy)

- Key investor focus areas into 3Q include (i) the magnitude of the Environmental Solutions growth inflection following five consecutive quarters of negative growth, (ii) the trajectory of underlying solid waste volume performance as event-related comparisons ease through 2H26, and (iii) the potential for outsized margin

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expansion in 2027 as Environmental Solutions returns to growth and AI-driven productivity initiatives begin to ramp, with management targeting at least \$100 mn of annual benefit from digital investments by 2028.

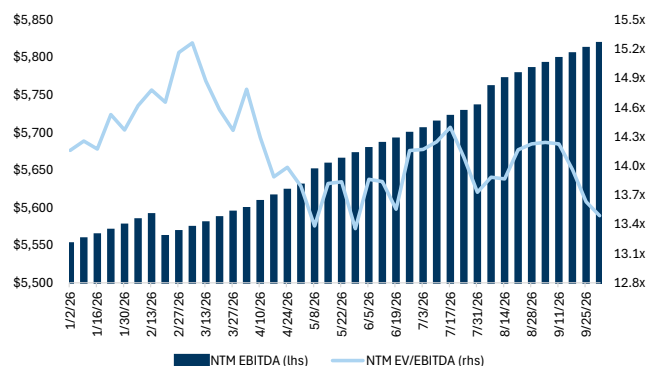
- On Environmental Solutions, we note that RSG's outlook for ~ flat full-year Environmental Solutions revenue, versus -5% growth in 1H26, would be largely met by simply lapping easier comparisons while holding recent activity levels relatively stable. Although, following roughly 12 months of subdued Emergency Response activity, the company is beginning to see more opportunities emerge.
- On volumes, we forecast solid waste volumes (as a percentage of total revenue) improving to ~-1.1% in 3Q from -1.6% in 2Q, driven almost entirely by easier event-related volume comparisons, which we estimate represents a -0.9% headwind in the quarter. Management expects volumes to then exit the year flat to slightly negative, as RSG will no longer be lapping the landfill event related volume comps in 4Q.
- Beyond the quarter, we see potential for RSG to begin providing early indications of its 2027 margin opportunity. We believe the company could deliver a year of outsized margin expansion (>50 bps yoy), driven by a return to growth in Environmental Solutions and as benefits from AI-driven routing and productivity initiatives beginning to take hold.
- For 3Q, our EBITDA estimate of \$1,451 mn is ~1% above FactSet consensus. Our forecast assumes organic growth accelerates to 4.7% from 3.5% in 2Q26, driven by improving Environmental Solutions activity, higher recycling commodity prices, and improving volume trends amid easier event-related volume comparisons. We forecast EBITDA margins declining 22 bps yoy, as favorable Solid Waste price/cost is more than offset by headwinds from high margin event-related volume comparisons, higher fuel costs, and M&A integration costs weighted towards 2H26.

Exhibit 21: RSG 3Q26 GSe vs consensus

	Gse 3Q26	Consensus 3Q26	Variance
RSG			
Revenue (\$ mn)	\$ 4,448	\$ 4,399	1.1%
% yoy	5.6%	4.4%	1.2%
% qoq	0.4%	(0.7%)	1.1%
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	1.7%	1.7%	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	2.3%	2.3%	-
EBITDA (\$ mn)	\$ 1,451	\$ 1,437	0.9%
% margin	32.6%	32.7%	(5)
% margin yoy (bps)	(22)	(17)	(5)
% margin qoq (bps)	49	54	(5)
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	34	34	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	33	33	-

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 22: RSG NTM EBITDA consensus estimate revisions vs NTM EV/EBITDA since start of 2026
\$ in mn



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Waste Connections (WCN, Buy)

- Our focus heading into 3Q26 is on (i) whether solid waste volumes trends improve

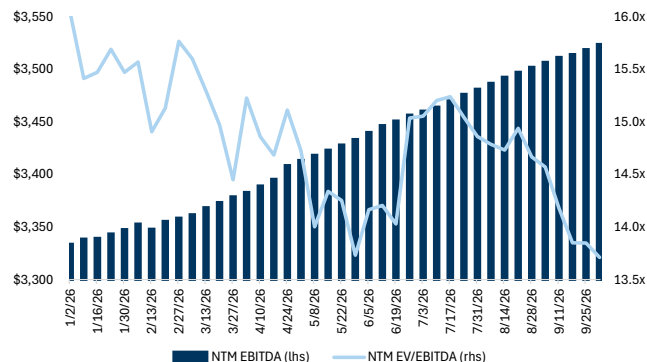
following declines of -1.5% in 1Q26 and -1.9% in 2Q26, (ii) potential updates on the Chiquita landfill remediation process following a new law in California (AB 28) that establishes state regulations around elevated temperature landfill events, and (iii) management's views on industry pricing trends heading into 2027.

- On volumes, Waste Connections noted last quarter that private haulers often take longer to adjust pricing in response to higher fuel costs and, in some cases, use that lag as a competitive opportunity. We continue to monitor WCN's negative volume variance relative to peers. WCN reported solid waste volumes of -1.9% last quarter, roughly in line with peers RSG and WM. However, peers cited an average ~1.5% headwind from lapping event-related volumes, while WCN did not, suggesting underlying volume performance may have been somewhat weaker relative to peers.
- On Chiquita, while investors remain highly focused on the evolution of the remediation process and its associated cash outflows, we note that WCN continues to generate strong free cash flow despite these headwinds. Even including ~\$100 mn of sustainability capex and ongoing Chiquita-related cash outflows, WCN is generating ~43% free cash flow conversion, or ~49% underlying free cash flow conversion excluding these items. WCN has been clear that it expects Chiquita cash outflows to decline in 2027. Last quarter, WCN noted that Chiquita-related cash outflows are currently tracking toward \$125 mn-\$150 mn for the full year. A key question will be whether AB 28, a new law signed by Governor Newsom that aims to establish new rules for managing elevated temperature landfill events, could alter this trajectory.
- Looking ahead to 2027, a key investor question is the trajectory of industry pricing. While a portion of waste contracts are tied to CPI with a lag, supporting accelerating pricing carryover on the indexed portion of the contract mix, fuel surcharge pass-throughs have effectively acted as an additional price increase for customers in 2026. As a result, a key focus this earnings season will be management commentary on open-market pricing, where waste companies have greater flexibility to set pricing, and whether the industry can sustain strong pricing momentum following a year of outsized all-in price increases (including fuel surcharges).
- For 3Q, our EBITDA estimate of \$890 mn is 0.4% above FactSet consensus as we expect tailwinds in E&P and recycling prices to balanced softer volume trends. Our forecast assumes organic growth of ~4.5%, in line with 2Q26 levels. We forecast EBITDA margins +25 bps yoy, driven by solid underlying margin expansion and benefits from higher recycling commodity prices, partially offset by the dilutive impact of fuel surcharges.

Exhibit 23: WCN 3Q26 GSe vs consensus

WCN	Gse	Consensus	
	3Q26	3Q26	Variance
Revenue (\$ mn)	\$ 2,615	\$ 2,604	0.4%
% yoy	6.4%	5.9%	0.4%
% qoq	2.1%	1.7%	0.4%
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	2.8%	2.8%	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	3.3%	3.3%	-
EBITDA (\$ mn)	\$ 890	\$ 886	0.4%
% margin	34.0%	34.0%	(0)
% margin yoy (bps)	26	26	(0)
% margin qoq (bps)	124	124	(0)
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	99	99	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	77	77	-

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 24: WCN NTM EBITDA consensus estimate revisions vs NTM EV/EBITDA since start of 2026
\$ in mn

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Casella Waste Systems (CWST, Buy, on CL)

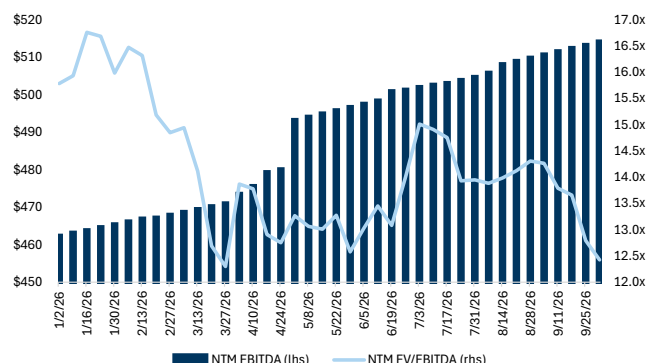
- Heading into 3Q, we will be looking for (i) greater clarity on the extent to which rising diesel prices could be a headwind to full-year EBITDA, (ii) whether Mid-Atlantic operational performance continues to inflect positively, and (iii) the potential for continued outsized growth in CWST's disposal business.
 - On rising diesel prices, we note that recent investor questions have centered on whether CWST is able to pass through indirect diesel fuel inflation costs (in addition to direct fuel inflation) through fuel surcharges. While CWST's disclosures suggest that fuel surcharges primarily offset direct fuel inflation (rather than indirect), we note that the company has contractual flexibility to adjust the majority of its core pricing at any point during the year.
 - In the Mid-Atlantic, we have already seen signs of operational improvement. CWST completed its lead-to-cash systems integration and integrated customer payment portal in early May and has since shifted its focus to route consolidations and automated truck conversions. In 2Q, Mid-Atlantic segment margins inflected positive yoy, with pricing improving to +4.7%, and volumes declining just 0.4%, compared to +3.6% pricing and -3.8% volumes in 1Q26. We will be looking for continued margin expansion and sustained mid-single-digit organic growth in 3Q26. Management is targeting \$5 mn of operating cost reductions in 2026, which we expect to be weighted toward 4Q, with an additional \$10 mn targeted over the following two years.
 - Last quarter, CWST saw landfill volumes accelerate to +8.5% yoy, while landfill pricing increased +4% yoy. Management sees a path to increase landfill pricing toward 5%+ over time as the market appears to be tightening further. Management recently noted that a rail facility in New Jersey had been putting modest downward pressure on the broader Northeast market; however, that facility is now at capacity. In addition, one of the key disposal facilities in the New York market, the WIN-owned Hudson Falls incinerator, has announced plans to close at the end of 2026. CWST also noted that Albany has announced plans to close its landfill.

- Our 3Q EBITDA estimate for CWST of \$135 mn compares with consensus of \$136 mn. Our ~6.2% organic growth forecast is underpinned by industry-leading ~5% solid waste price + volume growth, as well as a >1% tailwind from fuel surcharges. We forecast margins down ~60 bps yoy as strong underlying margin expansion is more than offset by the dilutive impact of fuel surcharges, M&A, the ramp-down of the North Country landfill, and continued mix headwinds in National Accounts.

Exhibit 25: CWST 3Q26 GSe vs consensus

	Gse 3Q26	Consensus 3Q26	Variance
CWST			
Revenue (\$ mn)	\$ 558	\$ 563	(0.8%)
% yoy	15.1%	16.0%	(1.0%)
% qoq	2.7%	3.6%	(0.9%)
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	8.4%	8.4%	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	7.6%	7.6%	-
EBITDA (\$ mn)	\$ 135	\$ 136	(1.0%)
% margin	24.1%	24.2%	(4)
% margin yoy (bps)	(58)	(54)	(4)
% margin qoq (bps)	145	149	(4)
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	102	102	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	145	145	-

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 26: CWST NTM EBITDA consensus estimate revisions vs NTM EV/EBITDA since start of 2026
\$ in mn

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

■ GFL (GFL, Neutral).

- Heading into 3Q, conversations with investors on GFL have centered primarily on the potential for an update on take-private interest, as the Board previously formed a special committee to oversee discussions. We noted last quarter that GFL's CEO and founder Patrick Dovigi stated he is not a seller and would roll 100% of his equity in a potential deal. Management characterized both staying public and going private as attractive paths. Intra-quarter, a Bloomberg report indicated that two consortia were looking to make a bid for GFL.
- On July 1, prior to the initial reports of take-private interest, GFL was trading at \$37. Since then, RSG, WM, CWST, and WCN have seen their share prices decline by 8%, while GFL's share price has risen from \$37 to \$40.5. Based on our estimates, GFL currently trades at ~12x NTM EV/EBITDA (next four quarters), versus peers at ~13x.
- On the quarter itself, as of today, we note that portions of consensus have not yet updated estimates to reflect the recently closed SECURE acquisition. We recently updated our GFL estimates to reflect the closing of the previously announced acquisition of SECURE Waste, raising our 2026-2028 EBITDA estimates to \$2,482 mn/\$3,062 mn/\$3,236 mn from \$2,292 mn/\$2,475 mn/\$2,630 mn. Our 3Q EBITDA estimate is \$669 mn versus \$622 mn prior to incorporating the SECURE acquisition.

Clean Harbors (CLH, Neutral)

- Key focus areas heading into 3Q include (i) the potential for Safety-Kleen to

outperform expectations amid the sharp increase in base oil refining spreads during the quarter, and (ii) the net impact of higher oil prices and refining spreads on Environmental Services.

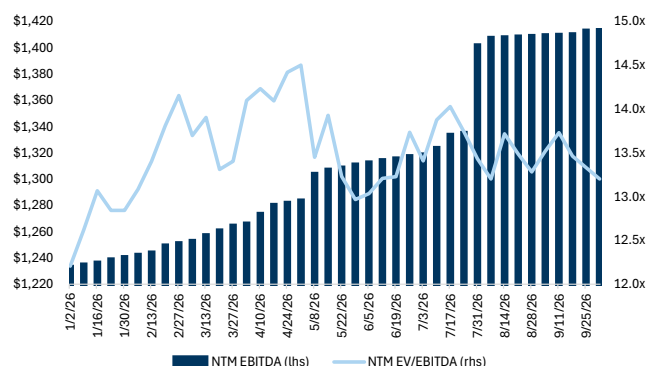
- Our base oil price tracker increased 7% sequentially and 42% yoy in 3Q, with current run-rate pricing 5% above the 3Q average. The VGO-based Group II base oil crack has also moved sharply higher, suggesting scope for meaningful margin expansion in the Safety-Kleen Sustainability Solutions segment. As such, we see upside to both consensus 3Q estimates and management's Safety-Kleen Sustainability Solutions EBITDA outlook of \$275 mn. In this note, we raise our 3Q Safety-Kleen Sustainability Solutions EBITDA estimate to \$115 mn from \$100 mn and increase our full-year estimate to \$321 mn from \$286 mn. We view risk to our 3Q and full year Safety-Kleen estimates as skewed to the upside.
- Within Environmental Services, we note that potential turnaround deferrals could continue to weigh on Industrial Services margins and growth. As a potential offset, the stronger oil price environment has historically been well correlated with volumes across other parts of CLH's Environmental Services business.
- Our 3Q EBITDA estimate of \$415 mn compares with FactSet consensus of \$405 million. Our estimate embeds ~8% organic growth, with EBITDA margins expanding 380 bps yoy, largely driven by the sharp increase in base oil prices and refining spreads during the quarter. Of our 30% 3Q EBITDA growth forecast, ~23% is driven by higher base oil prices and refining spreads.

Exhibit 27: CLH 3Q26 GSe vs consensus

	Gse	Consensus	
CLH	3Q26	3Q26	Variance
Revenue (\$ mn)	\$ 1,699	\$ 1,721	(1.3%)
% yoy	9.6%	11.1%	(1.5%)
% qoq	(2.1%)	(0.8%)	(1.3%)
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	(1.1%)	(1.1%)	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	0.9%	0.9%	-
EBITDA (\$ mn)	\$ 415	\$ 405	2.5%
% margin	24.5%	23.5%	92
% margin yoy (bps)	379	288	92
% margin qoq (bps)	88	(3)	92
5- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	(71)	(71)	-
10- year avg: 3Q vs 2Q sequential	(19)	(19)	-

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Exhibit 28: CLH NTM EBITDA consensus estimate revisions vs NTM EV/EBITDA since start of 2026
\$ in mn



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

- **OPAL Fuels (OPAL, Sell):** Since 2Q results, D3 RIN prices have declined from \$2.47 to \$2.28. This compares with OPAL's full year D3 RIN guidance, which assumes D3 RIN prices of \$2.45. The key focus this quarter will be how OPAL approaches RIN sales amid a lower-priced environment, particularly whether the company matches RIN sales with production or defers sales in anticipation of higher pricing in the future.

Valuation and estimate changes

Waste Management (WM, Buy): In this note, we lower our 12-month price target to \$241 from \$275, based on 13.0x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA (from 14.5x), reflecting lower sector valuation multiples amid rising interest rates. We also make modest estimate revisions to reflect mark-to-market adjustments for recycling commodity prices and diesel, though the net impact to our estimates is de minimis. Key risks include M&A integration execution, a slowdown in GDP or industrial production, lower D3 RIN prices, and weaker OCC prices.

Republic Services (RSG, Buy): We lower our 12-month price target to \$246 from \$256, based on 14.5x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA (from 15x), reflecting lower sector valuation multiples amid rising interest rates. We also make modest estimate revisions to reflect mark-to-market adjustments for recycling commodity prices and diesel, though the net impact to our estimates is de minimis. Key risks to the downside include M&A integration risk, a slowdown in GDP or industrial production, lower D3 RIN prices, and weaker OCC prices.

Waste Connections (WCN, Buy): We lower our 12-month price target to \$185 from \$215, based on 15.0x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA (from 17x), reflecting lower sector valuation multiples amid rising interest rates. We also make modest estimate revisions to reflect mark-to-market adjustments for recycling commodity prices and diesel, though the net impact to our estimates is de minimis. Key risks to the downside include a lack of value-enhancing M&A, a slowdown in GDP or industrial production, lower D3 RIN prices, and weaker OCC prices.

Casella Waste Systems (CWST, Buy, on CL): We lower our 12-month price target to \$112 from \$120 based on 15.5x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA (from 16.5x), reflecting lower sector valuation multiples amid rising interest rates. We also make modest estimate revisions to reflect mark-to-market adjustments for recycling commodity prices and diesel, though the net impact to our estimates is de minimis. Risks include accelerating cost inflation, M&A integration risk, and increased competition for acquisitions.

GFL (GFL, Neutral): We lower our 12-month price targets in this note to C\$64/\$45 USD from C\$68/\$49 USD, based on 12x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA (from 12.7x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA). Our lower valuation reflects lower sector valuation multiples amid rising interest rates. Key risks include: (+) If volumes or recycling prices accelerate off current levels, (+) M&A has historically been value add for the industry, (+) If GFL proves out rising FCF conversion over coming years, (-) If GDP or industrial production slows from current levels, and (-) If D3 RIN prices were to decline significantly from current levels.

Clean Harbors (CLH, Neutral): We raise our 2026-2027 EBITDA estimates to \$1.425 bn / \$1.499 bn from \$1.392 bn / \$1.463 bn to reflect higher base oil prices and refining spreads. Our 2028 EBITDA estimate of \$1.563 bn is largely unchanged. However, we lower our 12-month price target to \$332 (from \$356) based on 12.5x EV/EBITDA, from 13.5x previously. While our EBITDA estimates move higher, our valuation multiple moves lower to reflect lower sector valuation multiples amid rising interest rates, as well as an EBITDA base that incorporates peak levels of base oil pricing and refining spreads. If Safety-Kleen Sustainability Solutions were to revert to 2025 EBITDA levels over time, it would represent a 13% total company EBITDA headwind. Key risks to the upside include

higher base oil spreads, increased PFAS-related activity, and stronger-than-expected Industrial Services growth. Key risks to the downside include weaker miles driven, lower base oil pricing, and potential headwinds from incinerator mix.

OPAL Fuels (OPAL, Sell). We lower our 2026-2028 EBITDA estimates by ~5% on lower D3 RIN prices (to \$95/\$117/\$134 mn from \$100/\$124/\$140 mn). We revise our 12-month price target to \$1.90 from \$2.20 previously, applying an unchanged 7x EV/EBITDA multiple to our updated estimates. Risks include: Higher D3 RIN prices, positive regulatory developments, potential M&A, 45Z production tax credit drives positive estimate revisions.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Adam Bubes, CFA and Anuj Khandelwal, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

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Price target and rating history chart(s)

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compendium can be found in the latest relevant published research

Target price history table(s)

Casella Waste Systems Inc. (CWST)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
04-May-26	120.00	86.40
20-Feb-26	114.00	95.46
31-Oct-25	111.00	88.57
14-Feb-25	125.00	111.36
12-Dec-24	122.00	108.20
02-Aug-24	113.00	105.46
10-Jul-24	110.00	101.64
26-Apr-24	102.00	90.06
15-Apr-24	105.00	95.64

Republic Services (RSG)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
07-Aug-26	256.00	214.56
24-Nov-25	255.00	215.16
25-Apr-25	280.00	243.56
14-Feb-25	265.00	231.37
12-Dec-24	239.00	210.13
30-Oct-24	232.00	198.81
15-Apr-24	230.00	187.24
28-Feb-24	209.00	185.95

GFL Environmental (GFL)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
02-Sep-26	49.00	42.59
31-Jul-26	48.00	41.32
15-Jul-26	47.00	38.92
30-Apr-26	49.00	40.11
13-Feb-26	47.00	43.31
24-Nov-25	50.00	45.19
01-May-25	56.00	49.84
26-Feb-25	54.00	44.36
07-Nov-24	50.00	45.50
08-Oct-24	49.00	40.70
01-Aug-24	46.00	40.11
21-Feb-24	42.00	35.43
03-Nov-23	38.00	29.93

GFL Environmental (GFL.TO)

Date of report	Target price (C\$)	Closing price (C\$)
31-Jul-26	68.00	57.89
30-Apr-26	66.00	54.50
13-Feb-26	64.00	58.99
24-Nov-25	71.00	63.82
26-Feb-25	78.00	63.63
07-Nov-24	70.00	63.09
08-Oct-24	66.00	55.51
01-Aug-24	64.00	55.60
15-Apr-24	58.00	46.33
21-Feb-24	57.00	47.90
03-Nov-23	52.00	40.88

OPAL Fuels Inc. (OPAL)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
15-Jul-26	2.20	2.36
11-May-26	2.10	2.19
16-Mar-26	2.40	2.73
07-Nov-25	2.10	2.09
09-May-25	2.00	2.20
08-Apr-25	1.75	1.35
17-Mar-25	2.00	2.10
22-Jan-25	3.40	3.23
08-Aug-24	3.90	3.68
10-Jul-24	4.50	3.95
14-Mar-24	5.00	4.84

Waste Management (WM)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-Jul-26	275.00	226.33
30-Apr-26	270.00	232.55
24-Nov-25	256.00	211.84
30-Jan-25	262.00	222.43
29-Oct-24	253.00	219.11
25-Jul-24	250.00	199.92
26-Apr-24	255.00	210.10
15-Apr-24	253.00	205.36
13-Feb-24	230.00	199.49
25-Oct-23	202.00	164.07

Waste Connections (WCN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
23-Jul-26	215.00	167.99
23-Apr-26	211.00	168.89
13-Feb-26	206.00	160.26
24-Nov-25	202.00	173.15
24-Apr-25	215.00	196.72
28-Oct-24	202.00	176.91
15-Apr-24	199.00	165.77
14-Feb-24	181.00	164.12
26-Oct-23	158.00	127.88

Clean Harbors (CLH)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
29-Jul-26	356.00	326.34
15-Jul-26	318.00	303.37
08-Apr-26	306.00	302.58
19-Feb-26	268.00	281.34
20-Jan-26	253.00	256.31
24-Nov-25	228.00	215.06
19-Mar-25	220.00	196.76
20-Feb-25	250.00	212.18
12-Dec-24	267.00	247.48
30-Oct-24	246.00	235.15
31-Jul-24	256.00	238.73
02-May-24	223.00	205.55
15-Apr-24	207.00	194.64

Waste Connections (WCN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
22-Feb-24	196.00	182.45
01-Nov-23	180.00	147.34

Clean Harbors (CLH)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
22-Feb-24	196.00	182.45
01-Nov-23	180.00	147.34

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